

# Standard Operating Procedure

## Security Signage & Window/Door Decal Removal and Replacement

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| Document No.     | SOP-LV-036                                                       |
| Effective Date   | July 26, 2026                                                    |
| Revision         | 1.0                                                              |
| Review Date      | July 26, 2027                                                    |
| Applicable Sites | All commercial and residential client sites (Ontario & Manitoba) |
| Prepared By      | _____ (Operations / H&S Lead)                                    |
| Approved By      | _____ (Owner / Principal)                                        |

### 1. Purpose

This procedure establishes safe and consistent practices for removing worn, faded, or outdated security signage and window/door decals and replacing them with current signage at client sites. It is intended to protect technicians from cutting and chemical exposure hazards and to protect client glass, paint, and finished surfaces from damage during removal and reinstallation.

### 2. Scope

Applies to all technicians who remove and replace security company decals, alarm signage, camera notice stickers, access control labels, and similar adhesive signage on client windows, doors, and frames. Covers hand-blade removal, adhesive remover use, and decal reinstallation. Does not cover permanent vinyl wraps, large-format graphics, or exterior signage requiring powered tools — see a separate procedure if applicable.

### 3. Definitions

- Self-Retracting Blade Holder: A utility knife or scraper in which the blade automatically retracts into the handle when not under pressure, reducing laceration risk.
- Adhesive Remover: A chemical solvent (e.g., Goo Gone or equivalent) used to dissolve residual adhesive after decal removal.
- Dwell Time: The time an adhesive remover is left on a surface to break down adhesive before wiping.
- Substrate: The surface the decal is applied to (e.g., float glass, tinted glass, painted metal, powder-coated aluminum).

### 4. Responsibilities

#### Site Supervisor / Lead Technician

- Confirms the correct replacement decal is on hand before any existing signage is removed.
- Verifies the technician has the required PPE and an approved blade holder before work begins.

#### Technician

- Performs removal and reinstallation in accordance with this SOP and manufacturer guidance for the adhesive remover used.

- Inspects and photo-documents the surface before and after the work.
- Reports any pre-existing glass, paint, or frame damage to the site supervisor before starting removal.

## 5. Required Tools & Materials

- Self-retracting razor scraper (glass-safe blade) or plastic razor blade for delicate/tinted surfaces
- Adhesive remover (e.g., Goo Gone or equivalent)
- Heat gun or hair dryer (for stubborn adhesive, optional)
- Microfibre cloths and residue-safe glass cleaner
- Cut-resistant glove (non-dominant hand)
- Safety glasses
- Squeegee / felt-edge application card
- Replacement decal(s), confirmed correct for the site
- Sharps container or blade-safe disposal wrap

## 6. Safety Precautions

- Use a self-retracting blade holder at all times; the blade must never be carried exposed or stored loose in a pocket or tool pouch.
- Wear a cut-resistant glove on the hand steadying the surface; keep the blade hand clear of the glove hand's path at all times.
- Wear safety glasses when scraping overhead, on angled glass, or when using adhesive remover — splatter and dried adhesive fragments can flick toward the face.
- If the decal is above comfortable standing reach, follow SOP-LV-009 (Ladder Safety) rather than stretching or standing on furniture, sills, or railings.
- Work in a ventilated area when using adhesive remover indoors or in an enclosed vestibule; avoid prolonged inhalation.
- Dispose of used blades in a sharps container or wrap securely in tape before placing in regular waste — never discard a bare blade loose.

### **SAFETY NOTICE:**

Never force a blade against glass, tint film, or paint. If the decal will not lift freely, stop and apply heat or additional adhesive remover dwell time rather than increasing blade pressure.

Never use a metal blade on tinted, laminated, or film-coated glass — use a plastic razor to avoid scratching.

## 7. Procedure — Removal

- Confirm the correct replacement decal is on hand and matches the site requirement before removing the existing one.
- Photograph the existing decal and surrounding surface condition before starting.
- Hold the blade at a low, shallow angle (as close to flat against the surface as possible) and lift one corner of the decal.
- Peel slowly and steadily. If resistance increases, stop pulling and apply heat (heat gun/hair dryer on low) or additional adhesive remover rather than forcing the blade.
- Use the cut-resistant glove hand to steady the substrate, keeping fingers clear of the blade path.
- Remove the decal fully, minimizing the number of separate adhesive patches left behind.

## 8. Procedure — Adhesive Removal & Surface Prep

- Apply adhesive remover to the remaining residue and allow the manufacturer-recommended dwell time before wiping.
- Wipe with a microfibre cloth in the direction of any grain or tint film lines, not in a circular scrubbing motion, to avoid streaking or lifting film edges.
- Avoid over-saturating painted trim, tinted glass edges, or powder-coated frames — apply remover to the residue only, not the surrounding finished surface.
- Clean the full surface with a residue-safe, ammonia-free glass cleaner (ammonia can damage tint and UV films).
- Dry the surface fully and inspect for scratches, haze, or film damage before proceeding. Photograph and report any pre-existing or newly identified damage to the site supervisor immediately.

## 9. Procedure — New Decal Installation

- Confirm correct placement reference for the site (e.g., eye level, centered on the specified pane, standard offset from door edge).
- Peel the backing partially and align the decal before full adhesion — do not press down fully until placement is confirmed.
- Use a squeegee or felt-edge card to apply from center outward, working out air bubbles.
- Press edges firmly to ensure full adhesion, particularly in cold weather when adhesive is less tacky.
- Photograph the completed installation for the client file / CompanyCam record.

## 10. Surface-Specific Considerations

- Tinted or laminated glass: use a plastic blade only; metal blades can scratch or lift film edges.
- Painted doors and frames: keep the blade flat against the decal surface only — do not let the blade edge contact painted substrate.
- Powder-coated aluminum: avoid solvent-heavy or prolonged adhesive remover contact, which can dull or discolor the finish.
- Cold weather (below ~10°C): both old adhesive and new decal adhesive perform poorly in the cold; use a heat gun on low to keep the work area warm rather than forcing removal or rushing installation.

## 11. Documentation

- Before-and-after photos are required for every decal replacement and should be logged in CompanyCam or the client job file.
- Any surface damage identified (pre-existing or incidental) must be reported to the site supervisor the same day and documented per Apex's incident/damage reporting process.

## 12. References

- SOP-LV-009 — Ladder Safety (for decals above standing reach)
- Manufacturer safety data sheet (SDS) for adhesive remover product in use
- Ontario Occupational Health and Safety Act (OHSA) / Manitoba Workplace Safety and Health Act, as applicable